The Era *of* Capital Kingdoms

Contemporary capitalism has generated extraordinary prosperity, but who truly benefits from it? A small number of individuals now control fortunes comparable in scale to the annual spending of entire nations. Meanwhile, wealth continues to accumulate unevenly across households, occupations, and demographic groups.

The Era of Capital Kingdoms explores a world where invisible kingdoms are emerging, particularly in the United States, the symbolic heart of modern capitalism. Within these kingdoms, unelected kings wield enormous economic influence, privilege a small circle of elites, and leave ordinary people with only a fraction of the prosperity they help create.

Perhaps it is time to ask: ”Whom does contemporary capitalism truly serve?“ and ”Is it really the ultimate path to human happiness?“

Sources: IMF World Economic Outlook; Forbes Real-Time Billionaires (Oct. 17, 2026); Federal Reserve (DFA, SCF); U.S. Census Bureau (CPS, 2020 Census); FRED; historical U.S. immigrant-population data. Full references: GitHub README.

Billionaire Wealth vs Government Spending

This chart illustrates the relative scale of the personal net worth of the world's richest individuals and the projected annual government expenditures in 2026. Although they represent different economic measures—a stock and an annual flow—the comparison highlights the extraordinary scale of private fortunes.

- Top 10 Individuals combined wealth
- Individual net worth, Citizenship (as of 10/17/2026)
- Government expenditure forecast (US$ billions)



Elon Musk



Larry Page



Sergey Brin

Jensen Huang



Michael Dell



Mark Zuckerberg



Jeff Bezos



Larry Ellison



Portugal



Colombia



Warren Buffett



South Africa



Steve Ballmer



Vietnam



Bangladesh



Indonesia



Saudi Arabia



Mexico



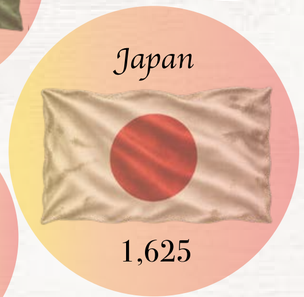
Australia



India



Russia



Japan



Top 10 individuals
combined wealth

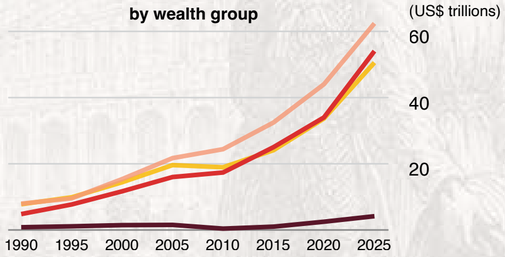
United States
12,482

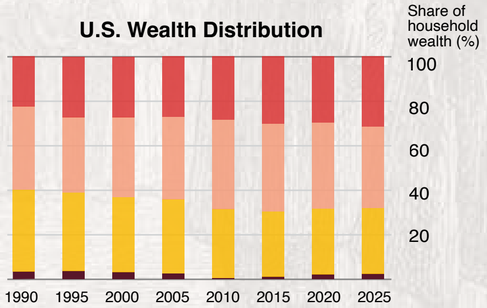


Germany

Who Owns America's Wealth

These charts reveal the unequal distribution of America's wealth. In 2025, the top 1% owned 31.5%, the top 10% held 68%, and the wealthiest half controlled 97.6% of total household wealth. Strikingly, such extreme concentration exists in one of the world's wealthiest economies.

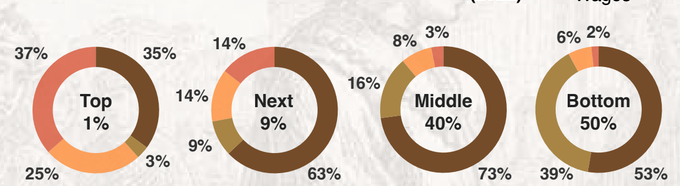




Money Works, the Gap Widens

Wages accounted for most income among middle-income households, while the richest 1% received a much larger share from businesses and investments. These charts reveal how income sources differ across economic groups, highlighting the advantages of owning capital rather than relying solely on wages.

Note: “Other” includes Social Security, retirement benefits, and government transfers. Bottom 50% includes retirees and households relying on them.



“Does immigration matter?”

Immigration is often at the center of debates over economic opportunity and inequality. The left chart compares median earnings across racial and ethnic groups, while the right chart examines the relationship between the foreign-born population share and income inequality in the United States.

Note: They do not establish that immigration causes income inequality. The Gini coefficient measures income inequality, with higher values indicating greater inequality.

